

Max Potapov

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Summary

Senior Front-End Engineer with 10+ years on distributed teams across the US and Europe. Core stack: React, Next.js, and TypeScript. Deep specialty in ProseMirror-based rich-text editors, including collaborative editing and change tracking. Led front-end at Chapterly for four years across two integrated Next.js apps. Earlier worked on Writers.Work (led to acquisition with \$13.8M lifetime payment volume) and Yandex.Market (20M+ MAU). EU Blue Card eligible under §18b AufenthG (recognized university degree, Anabin-verified). Employer provides only the job offer; all visa steps handled independently.

Skills

Core Stack: TypeScript, JavaScript, React, Next.js, TanStack Query, HTML, CSS, Tailwind, Zod, ProseMirror, TipTap, Drizzle ORM, tRPC, Node.js

Cloud & Platforms: Firebase, Sentry, Stripe, AWS, Heroku, Vercel

AI/LLM: OpenAI API, Vercel AI SDK, Claude Code, Codex, Cursor

Tools: Vitest, React Testing Library, Playwright, Storybook

Concepts: SSR/SSG/ISR, RSC, Component Composition, PWA, Core Web Vitals, Accessibility, CI/CD

Experience

Senior Front-End Engineer

Nov 2025 - Present

Marker (London-based word processor) via Emergence Engineering (Budapest, Hungary)

Remote

- Built reversible join/split tracking across text block types for Marker's suggestion-mode editor (recording block joins so a revert can split them back). Shipped in alpha.
- Designed reversible structural change tracking for suggestion mode across arbitrarily nested block structures. A capability no existing ProseMirror or TipTap implementation handled at the time.
- Traced a set of recurring issues (cursor jumps, wrong-character deletion) that surfaced only with hidden inline marks to contenteditable's undefined behavior, landed a styling approach that avoids them, and extended e2e coverage to both cases.
- Made the suggestion-mode codebase agent-ready with a context map, scoped context files, and ADRs; grew Playwright e2e coverage from ~20 to 150+ tests as the agent verification layer.

Lead Front-End Engineer

Dec 2019 - Oct 2025

Chapterly (writing and e-publishing platform), based in Spokane, WA, USA

Remote

- Led Chapterly's front end from first commit through 4 years of production operation, owning two Next.js apps and shared Firebase architecture that sustained ~33M monthly Firestore reads across ~6TB of user content.
- Architected Chapterly's chapter-based collaborative editor on React, ProseMirror, and Firebase with offline support and OT-based sync. Manuscripts routinely span 100+ chapters per book.
- Integrated Chapterly's subscription billing on Stripe end-to-end, backend and client. Powered \$277k peak ARR across ~12,500 lifetime paid subscribers.
- Designed Chapterly's AI writing assistant end-to-end as a NestJS service on Heroku backed by Firestore, integrated into onboarding and the editor.
- Led a team of up to 5 engineers across three time zones for four years. Set the architecture and engineering standards both apps were built on.
- Drove the technical revival of Writers.Work after a failed post-acquisition rewrite triggered 16 months of decline. Refactored Laravel hot paths, added MySQL indexes, and migrated EC2 to Heroku, cutting AWS costs 33%. Over the five months after the work shipped, the decline reversed: net payment volume grew from \$122k to \$387k, and new customers from 2.7k to 9.1k.

Senior Front-End Engineer

Nov 2017 - Dec 2019

Writers.Work (toolset for freelance writers), based in Austin, TX, USA

Remote

- Led front-end development of Writers.Work's React SPA from concept through launch and acquisition. Product processed \$13.8M lifetime payment volume across 315k customers.

- Built the drag-and-drop profile builder and Stripe Connect onboarding for freelancer service sales.
- Engineered the Firebase-to-Algolia synchronization pipeline behind the job board's near-real-time search.

Front-End Engineer

Dec 2015 - Nov 2017

Textografo (visual diagramming platform), based in Barcelona, Spain

Remote

- Shipped diagramming primitives (mind maps, flowchart subprocesses) in the React and JointJS canvas.
- Set up automated cross-browser visual testing (Nightwatch, Sauce Labs) for the diagram renderer.

Front-End Engineer

Dec 2013 - Dec 2015

Yandex.Market (e-commerce platform within Yandex, 20M+ MAU)

- Integrated the acquired Multiship product into Yandex.Market's stack, rebuilding the front end on internal frameworks; opened the service to 15k+ retailers on the platform.

Front-End Engineer

Oct 2012 - Dec 2013

Multiship (e-commerce logistics service aggregation platform)

- Built a low-code integration system that allowed merchants to onboard without manual API integration work from the engineering team.

Education

Bachelor's Degree in Applied Informatics

2012

National Research University "Moscow Power Engineering Institute" (MPEI)